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DATA CENTER
ENTERPRISE SERVICE STANDARD

See Also:
RCW 43.105.020 Definitions
RCW 43.105.054 WaTech Governance
RCW 43.105.265 Enterprise-based strategy for information technology
RCW 43.105.375 Use of state data center or commercial cloud computing services

1. PURPOSE

This standard establishes the statewide service capability, Data Center, as an enterprise service under EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy. A Washington state agency must not adopt, build, expand, or renew a service with similar capabilities unless it has an approved waiver or exemption (see Section 5).

2. SCOPE

1. The Data Center must be used to house physical IT infrastructure, including but not limited to servers, storage systems, and network equipment.
2. This standard does not limit state agencies from hosting systems with third-party, commercial cloud service providers.

3. APPLICABILITY

The scope of this standard applies to all state agencies (as defined in RCW 43.105.020).

4. ENTERPRISE SERVICE CAPABILITIES

The Data Center enterprise service designation encompasses the following service capabilities:

1. **Basic data center service:** Provides core infrastructure and facility support for hosting, operating, and maintaining IT systems, including:
    a. **IT equipment enclosures:** Houses and protects servers and networking hardware in secure, organized racks or cabinets.
    b. **Power and cooling:** Supplies reliable electrical power and maintains optimal environmental conditions to ensure continuous IT system operation.
    c. **Fire system:** Detects and suppresses fires using integrated detection, alarm, and extinguishing technologies to protect equipment and personnel.

2. **Physical security:** Ensures controlled access and protection of the facility through 24/7/365 surveillance, access controls, and monitoring systems.
3. **Shipping and receiving:** Manages the secure intake and dispatch of IT equipment and materials entering or leaving the data center.
4. **Industry Tier 3 standards:** 99.982% uptime and capable of meeting third-party regulatory compliance requirements.

5. WAIVERS AND EXEMPTIONS TO THIS STANDARD

In accordance with POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard, agencies may qualify for a waiver or exemption from compliance with this standard. Agencies may request an exemption for situations that meet one of the following criteria:

1. **Temporary IT equipment** that is associated with a natural disaster, emergency response, or other unplanned events in cases where the Data Center Service is otherwise unavailable for use.
2. IT equipment required to support Mission-Critical or Business-Essential field operations and is one or more of the following types:
    a. **Consumer electronics devices,** such as personal computers, printers, mobile devices, or multifunctional output devices.
    b. **Internet of things devices,** such as sensors, trackers, smart devices, wearables, appliances, IP cameras, lights, TVs, conferencing systems, environmental monitoring systems, etc.
    c. **Building management systems devices,** such as heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) systems; elevators; parking; video surveillance; security systems; etc.
    d. **Access control system readers and sensors,** such as radio-frequency identification (RFID) badges and biometric scanners.
    e. **Tactile human interface equipment,** such as lab equipment, clinical equipment, forensics, etc.
    f. **Transportation Systems Management Operations and mobility system sensors and devices,** such as field deployed sensors, devices, and control equipment including roadside traffic operations, public transit vehicles, unmanned vehicles, land, water, and aircraft trackers, ferry vessels, mobile command centers, mobile disaster recovery platforms when such components require local or mobile operation.
    g. **Systems required by the Maritime Transportation Security Act (MTSA) and or United States Coast Guard (USCG) regulations** to remain operational during loss of commercial power or wide area network connectivity, to the extent that such requirements necessitate local or on-site hosting.
    h. **Site-dependent systems**, communications equipment such as radio, satellite, microwave receivers and transmitters. Server deployments that operate locally and aggregate to a primary server in the SDC or QDC. Secondary AD Domain Controllers in locations other than the data centers.

i. **Manufacturing and industrial system sensors, trackers, and devices,** such as smart agriculture, robotics, machine controls systems, and supervisory control and data acquisition (SCADA) systems.

j. **Locally operated equipment rooms** that only support local office building operations, print rooms, file share, on-site client configurations, network and telecommunication equipment.

k. **Systems with airgaps** (physically not connected to state government networks), such as building management systems or building physical security systems.

REFERENCES

1. Service Catalog Page: Data Center Service
2. Definition of Terms Used in WaTech Policies and Reports
3. EA-02 – Establishing an Enterprise Service Policy
4. POL-01-01-PR Technology Policies and Standards Waiver Procedure
5. POL-01-02-S Technology Policy and Standard Waiver Request Standard
6. RCW 43.105.054 WaTech powers and duties
7. RCW 43.105.375 Use of state data center or commercial cloud computing services
8. RCW 43.105.450 State agency information technology security

CONTACT INFORMATION

For questions about this policy, please email the WaTech Policy Mailbox.